

¡Encuentro! Teen-Parent Pilot Study Recruitment & Retention

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Background

- Minnesota surge in immigration: 40% of the Latino population is under 20 years of age.
- The growth of the Latino youth population, creates a compelling need for research identifying effective health promotion and prevention programs for this population.
- Youth development programs build on young peoples' strengths, and enhance protective factors within individual teens and their social contexts.
- It is important to understand challenges for Latinos to participate in research and to identify effective strategies to enroll and retain youth and families.

What is Encuentro?

- A pilot study of a teen-parent program to promote healthy youth development among Latino adolescents ages 11-14.
- Program developed by partners from Latino community & university using community-based participatory research (CBPR)
- Three host community organizations: Sojourner Truth Academy & Sabathani Community Center in Minneapolis; Guadalupe Alternative Programs in St.Paul
- Program topics: Culture, Family, Health, Youth Life Preparation
- 16-week program: held after-school hours on weekdays or on Saturdays
- Youth: two 2-hour sessions each week=32 sessions; Adults: weekly 2-hour sessions= 16 sessions

Purpose

To describe methods used to inform, recruit and retain Latino parents and young teens in health promotion research.

Literature Review

Goal: To examine barriers and effective strategies for recruiting and retaining Latino youth and families in health related research

Two recruitment strategies:

1. **Proactive**: direct, face-to face contact with prospective participants to provide information about the study.
2. **Reactive:** indirect interactions with potential participants through flyers, advertisements, radio, and word-of mouth from community staff or family members.

Barriers	Strategies to Address Barriers
Recruitment	
Mistrust	✓ Partnering with known individuals or groups within community; utilizing bicultural & bilingual recruiters ✓ Offering family focused events that emphasize Latino values of familismo, respeto, confianza, simpatia, & personalismo
Language	✓ Written materials & communicating in Spanish
Retention	
Practical Issues	✓ Flexible schedule, evening hours; convenient program sites; transportation; child care
Mistrust	✓ On-going personal contact; follow-up contacts; birthday cards/thank you cards
Time Commitment	✓ Incentives: money or gifts
Youth	
Practical Issues	✓ Flexible schedules: after school hours
Social Stigma	✓ Parental involvement & support from peers and others
Time commitment	✓ Incentives: gifts or academic credit

Discussion & Implications

- Pilot study participants were mostly immigrant mothers and first generation young adolescents.
- Two main points for health related research were identified from the literature review: 1) using reactive strategy is a best practice in recruiting Latino youth & families as participants; 2) building relationships/establishing trust is a best practice in retaining Latino participants.
- Encuentro's recruitment efforts resemble effective strategies found in the lit review (e.g. partnering with known community members and organizations, word of mouth).
- To maximize participant retention & honor personalismo, Encuentro may want to expand the use of ongoing personal contact strategies (e.g. birthday & holiday cards).

Encuentro Recruitment & Retention Methods

Participant Recruitment

Five strategies used to recruit families:

1. Staff from each host community organization recruited eligible families
2. Outreach events held at host organizations
3. Program flyers (Spanish & English) distributed in host sites neighborhoods
4. Study's community partners invited eligible families
5. Families who enrolled invited other eligible families

Participant Retention

- Program offered during after-school hours & on Saturdays
- Program developed in partnership with Latino community
- Transportation & meals provided
- Child care offered
- Incentives: **Youth** drawing for $5 gift card at each session; **Adults**: monthly drawing for $25 gift card
- Evaluation incentives: Youth & adults paid $25 for each pilot study survey

Findings:Descriptors of Pilot Study Participants

Demographics of Youth Pilot Study Participants (N=65)	
Gender (n=63)	
Female	28 (44.44%)
Male	35 (55.6%)
Age	
11 years	26 (40%)
12 years	14 (21.5%)
13 years	12 (18.5%)
14 years	13 (20%)
Grade in School	
4-5th grade	22 (33.8%)
6-7th grade	31 (47.7%)
8-9th grade	12 (18.5%)
% Born in US	55 (84.6%)
Race/Ethnicity (n=64)	
Latino	64 (100%)
Other	3 (4.7%)
Current living situation	
Live with mother & father	55 (84.6%)
Live with mother	7 (10.8%)
Live with another adult relative	3 (4.6%)
Language spoken at home (n=64)	
Mostly or only English	8 (12.5%)
Mostly or only Spanish	31 (48.4%)
Both English & Spanish	25 (39.1%)

Demographics of Parent Pilot Study Participants (N=49)	
Gender (n=48)	
Female	45 (93.8%)
Male	3 (6.2%)
% Born in US	2 (4.1%)
Race/Ethnicity	
Latino	48 (100%)
Other	1 (2.1%)
Relationship to youth in study (n=48)	
Mother	44 (91.8%)
Father	2 (4.1%)
Other	2 (4.1%)
% Single head of household	9 (4.1%)
Highest formal education (n=48)	
Elementary School	9 (18.7%)
High School	24 (50%)
College/ Trade School	15 (31.3%)
Language spoken at home	
Mostly or only English	2 (4.1%)
Mostly or only Spanish	45 (91.8%)
Both English & Spanish	2 (4.1%)

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